

Terms of Reference

Information Management Consultant/Interim MIMU Manager (SSA)

Yangon, Myanmar

Job Title: Information Management Consultant/Interim MIMU Manager
Level: Equivalent to L4 (SSA Contract)
Organization: OCHA Regional Office for Asia and the Pacific (OCHA-ROAP)
Duty Station: Yangon, Myanmar
Duration: Three months, with a possibility of a further extension based on explicit needs identified by the Humanitarian Coordinator and the availability of sufficient funds

1. Background

The Information Management officer from OCHA's Regional Office in Bangkok visited Yangon in January 2007 to review information management activities of the UN Country Team and advise the RC/HC on areas for development. Recommendations included strengthening geographic data standards to provide an inter-agency platform for data sharing, revising the terms of reference of the Vulnerability Unit, and devising methods for generating essential baseline data using analytical tools and the collective capacities of the humanitarian community.

These proposals were further developed and implemented through a short-term consultancy funded by OCHA-ROAP. The mission sought to harmonise the information management activities of IASC members through common standards and collaborative projects, so that reliable information can serve as a common foundation for project design, implementation and monitoring.

In June 2007, recognizing the need for centralized information management and collaboration among all humanitarian and development actors, the Inter-Agency Standing Committee (IASC) and UN Country Team have endorsed an expanded role of the Vulnerability Unit.

In July 2007, an IM consultant, funded by OCHA-ROAP, was hired for two months to assess the situation and to work with the IASC and donors to begin the establishment of the Myanmar Information Management Unit (MIMU). The unit will act as a common service to humanitarian and development partners, supporting coordination and decision-making by providing information analysis, products and services, and by promoting a common framework for data collection and management.

Building on the momentum of the initial consultancy, an interim MIMU Manager is needed, beginning October 2007, to complete the establishment of the unit, finalising TORs and the budget and working with the IASC to obtain financial support. Upon completion of the above, a permanent manager and other staff will be recruited.

The IM Consultant/Interim Manager will work under the overall supervision of the Myanmar UN Resident / Humanitarian Coordinator and is expected to undertake the following duties and responsibilities:

Initial Main Duties and Responsibilities:

- 1) Provide strategic guidance to the Resident/Humanitarian Coordinator on information management issues. Develop strategies to ensure the availability of data and systems necessary to support the work of the RC/HC and the IASC Country Team;
- 2) Review the operations of the Vulnerability Unit and its role vis-à-vis other information management bodies within the UN and NGO community and propose strategies for ensuring that the Vulnerability Unit addresses the needs of the RC/HC and Country Team;
- 3) Review existing information systems and teams within the IASC Country Team and propose strategies that will address gaps, resolve duplications and exploit opportunities to help the country team develop integrated and coordinated information resources;
- 4) Review existing geographic data standards and promote the adoption of a common system by the entire IASC country team;
- 5) Review the needs and availability of essential baseline information needed by UN agencies and NGOs and develop strategies to collect and manage this information. Consider techniques such as proxy indicators for this purpose;
- 6) Conduct a Data Readiness Assessment in consultation with OCHA's Regional Office for Asia and the Pacific in order to develop Myanmar's ability to manage information in the event of a sudden-onset emergency;

2. Additional Duties as necessary, amended October 2007:

- 1) Provide strategic guidance to the Humanitarian/Resident Coordinator, IASC/UN Country Team and stakeholders on data and information management for effective humanitarian and development programming;
- 2) Develop strategies to ensure availability of data necessary to support coordination and decision-making, with an emphasis on supporting common indicators and common needs assessment initiatives;
- 3) Liaise with UN agencies, NGOs, Sector/Cluster coordination groups, governmental actors and other partners to help identify their information requirements and to ensure that the information needed to support humanitarian coordination and operations is made commonly available;
- 4) Promote data standards (including Place Codes), develop standardized data collection and dissemination tools and processes, and support other information-sharing protocols, and the use of standardized metadata;
- 5) Establish and lead inter-agency information management working group(s) to promote information-sharing, data standardization and interoperability and where appropriate, joint data development initiatives;
- 6) Manage the development and maintenance of common databases and templates that support coordination and information-based decision making, including:

- Common Indicators

- Common Assessment formats
 - Who, What, Where database
 - MyaInfo (DevInfo platform)
- 7) Ensure necessary data and staff support for Geographic Information Systems development, mapping and analysis;
 - 8) Conduct both simple and multi-dimensional analyses and seek ways of linking quantitative and qualitative information and analysis across sectors;
 - 9) Ensure that the Unit provides timely, high-quality and demand driven information products and services including:
 - technical support to partners and assistance on data collection, management;
 - base maps, atlases and country gazetteers;
 - thematic maps presenting multi-sectoral information;
 - reports and summaries
 - 10) Maximize the extent that information and data is shared and disseminated among the IASC/UN Country Team and other humanitarian partners, ever mindful of sensitivity issues;
 - 11) Represent the Unit through briefings and other activities to the wider humanitarian community and provide reports on Unit activities as requested;
 - 12) Supervise the strategic and day-to-day management of the unit;
 - 13) Recruit, manage and train IMU staff in the performance of their duties, including staff development and regular assessment as well as providing support in key technical areas where possible;
 - 14) Any other duties as may be requested by the HC/RC, IASC/UN Country Team

Revised Qualifications / Experience

For an L-4 position, a candidate is normally expected to have:

Candidates with less experience or education than this may be offered the position at a lower grade.

- Advanced degree, preferably in humanitarian affairs, information management, political science, development studies, social sciences or a related field or the equivalent combination of education and experience in a related area.
- A minimum of 8 years of increasingly responsible professional experience, including management experience in information management, humanitarian affairs, emergency relief management, rehabilitation or development, or a related field for an UN Agency or NGO in an humanitarian or development environment;

For this position, the following qualifications are required:

- Demonstrated experience in understanding, managing and analyzing information at a strategic level and a clear understanding of how information can be used to improve humanitarian assistance delivery and development projects;
- Excellent inter-personal and liaison skills - to have the ability to work with UN Heads of Agency, IASC members, NGOs and senior government officials to build relationships and ensure cooperation;
- Knowledge of information management technical tools, including database development and use of GIS systems;
- Demonstrated ability to properly prioritize and manage complex operational tasks in a difficult environment;
- Possesses a strong service orientation;
- Ability to write clearly and concisely in English;

Desirable qualifications include:

- Experience working in Myanmar or SE Asia